Say it to your boss.

FOR AN EMPLOYEE: A MEETING, A ONE-TO-ONE OR A KICK-OFF

Four things to say

1. **What does success look like here?** Is 600 a target for every month, or for the quarter as a whole?
   Ask for clarity. Ask before you guess. Make the goal measurable.
2. I see a risk, and I would rather you heard it from me today: one person leaves in November, so we will be four, not five.
   Say it early. Say it today, with a fact.
3. I am fully behind the goal. My concern is the number. Would it be possible to **start at** 520?
   Disagree calmly. Common ground first. Then one concern and one option.
4. I would need two weeks to learn the new tool. I would appreciate it if you could let me know whether it changes the plan.
   Ask for what you need. Name what you need, and why.

TOO QUIET

Say the better version out loud first

~~Sure, no problem.~~	→ I can do it. What does success look like?
~~I will try my best.~~	→ I can **commit** to 520. Could we review it in four weeks?
~~Whatever works for you.~~	→ I am fully behind the goal. My concern is the number.
~~Sorry, I am a bit behind.~~	→ I see a risk. Here is what I need to **get back on track**.
~~Everything is fine.~~	→ I have one **concern**, and I would rather raise it now.

Four fears keep people quiet. Test the fear with one small sentence.

WHY WE STAY QUIET

Which fear is it?

1. My boss will take it personally.
2. It will cost me later.
3. I will look incompetent.
4. I will be the only one.
5. I do not have enough proof.
6. I will be seen as negative.

Ask yourself: has this really happened to me? Many people never test their fear.

MARINA'S GOAL

Score = likely result ÷ goal

600	57% below · with tool: 63% in
520	66% in · with tool: 73% above
480	72% above · with tool: 79% above

Invented numbers, a simple estimate for the lesson: 430 tickets a month with five people, 344 with four, 378 if the tool adds 10%. Below, in or above refers to the 60 to 70% sweet spot.

SAY THE NUMBERS OUT LOUD

Out loud, in English

600	six hundred
344	three hundred forty-four
520	five hundred twenty
60 to 70%	sixty to seventy percent
66%	sixty-six percent

Family 1 needs to
I'd like you to explain the priority. Never "I'd like that you explain".

Let, make, have: no to
Could you let me know? Never "let me to know".

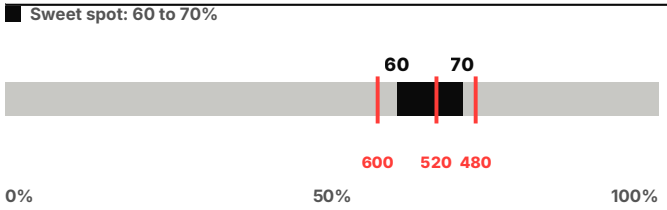
Suggest that + base form
I suggest that we move the date. Never "suggest us to move".

The not
didn't ask them to start · asked them not to start · didn't let them start · suggest that they not start.

Ask. Say. Need.

GOOGLE SCALE

An ambitious goal: the sweet spot



Red: Marina's score for each goal

Google says 60 to 70 percent is the sweet spot.

NUMBERS YOU CAN QUOTE

With the source

1980	the year Gabarro and Kotter published "Managing Your Boss" in Harvard Business Review
4 studies	in Detert and Edmondson's 2011 research on why people stay quiet at work
5 kinds	of unspoken rules about speaking up, measured in those studies
180 teams	studied by Google: psychological safety came first of five dynamics

Ask for clarity. Say it early. Disagree calmly. Ask for what you need.

THREE FAMILIES

The patterns

1. **"I would urge you to reconsider the date."**
   verb + person + to + verb. ask · expect · urge · encourage · advise · would appreciate · get
2. **"Would you let me set my own priorities?"**
   let · make · have + person + verb. Only three verbs. No to after the person. Get is different: get + person + to + verb.
3. **"I propose that we set the goal at 520."**
   suggest · recommend · propose · insist + that + person + verb. Formal. The verb stays in the base form: that we move, that she join.

WHERE THE NOT GOES

Three places

1. **"I didn't ask them to start." × "I asked them not to start."**
   Two places
2. **"I didn't let them start." Never "I let them not start."**
   The first verb
3. **"I suggest that they not start." Never "that they don't start."**
   After that

BOSS?

Too much for a meeting

~~Frankly, this target is unrealistic and everyone knows it.~~	→ **"Could we look at what would have to be true for this target to be realistic?"**
~~I told you this would happen.~~	→ **"Here is what I am seeing, and what I would suggest we do next."**
~~With respect, you are not listening.~~	→ **"I may not have explained it well. Let me try again with one example."**
~~Fine. I will just do it, but do not blame me when it fails.~~	→ **"I can do it with these two conditions. If we cannot meet them, I will tell you straight away."**
~~That is not my job.~~	→ **"I am happy to help. Could we agree on what I should drop to make room for it?"**

WATCH OUT · FALSE FRIENDS

The word looks Portuguese, but

~~eventually~~ eventualmente	It means in the end, after a long time. For possibly, say possibly or if necessary. Say: We finished eventually.
~~actually~~ atualmente	It means in fact. For now, say currently. Say: We currently have four people.
~~comprehensive~~ compreensivo	It means complete and detailed. For understanding, say understanding. Say: She is an understanding boss.
~~sympathetic~~ simpático	It means feeling sorry for someone. For a nice person, say friendly. Say: He is very friendly.
~~compromise~~ compromisso	A compromise is an agreement in which each side gives something up. For a duty or a promise, say commitment.